Flourish
LEGAL WELL-BEING

The Beauty of "Good Enough" Parenting

When you're juggling parenthood and a career in the legal field, it's easy to feel like you're falling short. Good news: you don't have to be perfect, just "good enough," to raise happy, healthy kids.

What is "Good Enough Parenting"?

- Coined by physician and psychoanalyst Donald Winnicott.
- Well-adjusted kids don't need perfect parents — just consistent, "ordinary" love and care.
- Research shows "good enough" parenting produces positive child outcomes.

It's Normal to Struggle

- Parenting is hard, and no one is fully prepared for it.
- Struggling doesn't mean you're failing. It means you're a parent.

Managing Expectations

- You can't do everything.
- Focus on what your child *needs* rather than what you *want* to do for them.

Redefining Success

- Celebrate small wins and moments of connection.
- **Practical Exercise:** End each day by noting one parenting win, no matter how small.

"Forbidden Feelings" are Normal

- It's normal to feel frustration or doubt — even to wish you weren't a parent sometimes.
- These feelings don't make you a bad parent. They make you human.

Be Kind to Yourself

- Practice self-compassion.
- Remember that struggles and mistakes are part of parenting.
- **Practical Exercise:** Write a short letter to yourself, as if you were comforting a friend.